

eClerx — Complete Interview Preparation (Financial Markets Analyst)

Deep, from-scratch notes + question bank + behavioural answers — prepared for Apoorva Singh

How to use this document. *This is built assuming you know nothing and want to understand everything. For every concept you will see five layers: (1) What it is (plain meaning) → (2) Why it exists / how it's used → (3) How it impacts the company, market or your job → (4) Outside factors that move it → (5) A concrete example. Read it in order the first time; later, jump to the Q&A and behavioural sections to rehearse out loud.*

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Educational preparation material. Market data points are indicative — verify the latest numbers (repo rate, indices, USD/INR, crude) the day before your interview.

PART A — ORIENTATION (know the battlefield)

A1. What is eClerx? (be able to say this in 20 seconds)

What it is: eClerx is an Indian **KPO — Knowledge Process Outsourcing** company (founded 2000, headquartered in Mumbai, with large operations in Pune; listed on Indian stock exchanges; CEO Kapil Jain). It runs **middle-office and back-office operations** for global banks, asset managers and other Fortune-500 clients across financial markets, plus digital/creative and analytics services.

KPO vs BPO (a classic question): A **BPO** (Business Process Outsourcing) handles high-volume, rules-based, often voice/transactional work (e.g., call centres). A **KPO** handles **knowledge-intensive, judgement-based work** that needs domain expertise — e.g., supporting the trade lifecycle, reconciliations, regulatory reporting, KYC. eClerx is primarily a **KPO** (it also does some BPO). Say: "eClerx is a KPO — the work needs finance domain knowledge and judgement, not just data entry."

Why this matters to you: In the Financial Markets vertical, eClerx is the **operations engine behind investment banks** — when a bank executes thousands of trades, eClerx helps make sure each one is captured, confirmed, settled, reconciled and reported correctly.

A2. The role you're interviewing for

The finance roles sit in **Capital Markets / Financial Markets operations**. Common titles: *Financial Market Analyst, Analyst - Cash Securities Operations, Derivative Trade Support, Regulatory Compliance, Reference Data, Reconciliations*. (You may even see "Oasys Analyst" — Oasys/CTM is a DTCC trade-confirmation system.)

What you'll actually do day-to-day: support stages of the **trade lifecycle** for a client bank — capturing/validating trades, matching and confirming them with counterparties, chasing and resolving **breaks** (mismatches), supporting **settlement**, handling **corporate actions**, doing **reconciliations**, and preparing **reports**. It is **detail-oriented, deadline-driven, process work** — accuracy and communication matter more than fancy theory.

This is a MIDDLE/BACK-OFFICE role, not front-office trading. Be clear about that (next section).

A3. Front office vs Middle office vs Back office (know cold)

Think of a bank as a factory for trades:

- **Front office** = makes the money. Traders, sales, dealmakers. They *decide and execute* trades and face clients/markets.
- **Middle office** = manages risk and *supports* the trade. Risk management, product control, **trade support/confirmation**, P&L validation, limit monitoring. Sits between front and back.
- **Back office** = *processes and records*. **Settlement, reconciliation, reference/static data, regulatory reporting, corporate actions, custody.**

eClerx operates mainly in the middle and back office. *Example:* a trader (front office) sells an interest-rate swap; the middle office confirms the trade terms with the counterparty; the back office settles the cash flows, reconciles the books and reports the trade to the regulator.

A4. The interview process (what to expect)

Typically **3-4 rounds**, in roughly this order:

1. **Aptitude / online test** — quantitative, logical reasoning, English; sometimes basic finance.
2. **Versant / communication test** — automated spoken-English test (clarity & fluency).
3. **Technical / operations round** — trade lifecycle, derivatives, capital markets, Excel, your resume.
4. **HR round** — fit, stability, shift flexibility, salary.

Difficulty is rated **medium (~2.8/5)** — the bottleneck is usually communication + clarity of fundamentals, not advanced theory. **The Trade Life Cycle question is almost guaranteed** — master it.

PART B — FINANCE FOUNDATIONS (start from zero)

B1. What is a "financial market" and why does it exist?

What it is: A financial market is any place/system where **buyers and sellers trade financial assets** (shares, bonds, currencies, derivatives).

Why it exists: To connect people who **have money and want returns** (investors/savers) with people who **need money to grow** (companies, governments). It also lets people **manage risk** and **discover prices**.

How it impacts: Efficient markets let companies raise capital cheaply (build factories, hire), let savers earn returns (retirement, wealth), and signal the economy's health via prices.

Outside factors: interest rates, inflation, growth, □□/policy, global events — all move markets (Part F).

Example: Reliance needs Rs 10,000 cr to build a plant → it issues shares/bonds in the market → investors buy them hoping for returns → Reliance gets the cash. That transfer is the market's core job.

B2. The four core functions of markets (easy to recite)

1. **Capital raising** — channel savings into businesses.
2. **Liquidity** — let you convert assets to cash quickly by selling to someone else.
3. **Price discovery** — the constant buying/selling sets a fair price.
4. **Risk transfer** — derivatives/insurance let those who don't want a risk pass it to those who will take it for a price.

B3. Primary vs Secondary market (very common question)

- **Primary market:** securities are **created and sold for the first time**; the money goes **to the issuer** (the company/government). Example: an **IPO** (Initial Public Offering), or a new bond issue.

- **Secondary market: existing** securities are traded **between investors** on an exchange (NSE/BSE); the issuer gets **no new money** — but it provides **liquidity** and **price discovery**.
- **Link/impact:** A healthy secondary market (liquid, fairly priced) makes investors willing to buy in the primary market, which lowers the company's cost of raising capital.
- **Example:** Zomato's IPO (primary) raised money for Zomato; afterwards, you buying Zomato shares on NSE (secondary) just transfers ownership between investors.

B4. Money market vs Capital market

- **Money market: short-term** debt, maturity **under 1 year** — for managing day-to-day liquidity. Instruments: Treasury Bills (T-bills), Commercial Paper (CP), Certificates of Deposit (CD), call money, repo. Low risk, highly liquid.
- **Capital market: long-term** funding, **over 1 year** — **equity** and **long-term debt (bonds)**. Higher risk/return, drives capital formation.
- **Example:** A company covering a 60-day cash gap issues commercial paper (money market); the same company funding a 10-year factory issues bonds or shares (capital market).

B5. Who's who — participants and regulators

Participants: retail investors; **HNIs**; **institutional investors** — **FIIs/FPIs** (foreign), **DII**s (domestic: mutual funds, insurers like LIC, pension funds); banks; **hedge funds** (pooled, aggressive, often leveraged); **mutual funds** (pooled, regulated, for the public); proprietary trading desks; brokers; **custodians**; **clearing houses**.

Indian market infrastructure (memorise the chain):

- **SEBI** — securities markets regulator (protects investors, regulates exchanges/brokers/IPOs).
- **RBI** — central bank; monetary policy, money markets, government securities, currency.
- **NSE / BSE** — stock exchanges (where trades match).
- **NSE Clearing (NSCCL) / ICCL** — **clearing corporations / CCPs** (guarantee settlement).
- **NSDL / CDSL** — **depositories** (hold shares electronically in *demat* form).
- **IRDAI** (insurance), **PFRDA** (pensions).

Global equivalents to know: **DTCC** (US clearing/settlement + Oasys/CTM confirmation), **Euroclear/Clearstream** (Europe), **SWIFT** (secure messaging between banks).

PART C — ASSET CLASSES (the products you'll support)

*The role supports three asset classes: **Equity, Fixed Income (bonds), and Derivatives**. For each, the interviewer wants: what it is, how it's priced, how it trades (exchange vs OTC), the corporate actions/events on it, and what moves its value.*

C1. EQUITY (shares / stocks)

What it is: A share is a **unit of ownership** in a company. Own 1 share of 100 total = you own 1% of the company.

Why it's issued/used: Companies issue equity to **raise money they never have to repay** (unlike debt). Investors buy it for **dividends + capital gains** (price rising).

How it's priced: By **supply and demand** in the market, anchored to the company's expected **future earnings/cash flows**. Common yardstick: **P/E ratio** (Price ÷ Earnings per Share) — how many rupees you pay per Rs 1 of annual profit.

How it trades: Mostly on **exchanges** (NSE/BSE) in **dematerialised** form; settles **T+1** in India (one business day after trade).

Equity holder's position: last in line if the company is liquidated (paid after lenders) — higher risk, higher potential reward; usually carries **voting rights**.

Outside factors: interest rates (higher rates → lower valuations), earnings growth, economic growth, sentiment, FII flows.

Example: You buy 10 shares of TCS at Rs 3,500. If profits grow and the price rises to Rs 4,000, your capital gain is Rs 500/share; you may also receive dividends along the way.

C2. FIXED INCOME (bonds / debt)

What it is: A bond is a **loan you give to a company/government**. They pay you periodic interest (the **coupon**) and return the **face value (principal)** at **maturity**.

Why it's used: Issuers borrow without giving up ownership; investors get **predictable income** and lower risk than equity.

Key terms: **Face/par value** (e.g., Rs 1,000), **coupon** (interest rate), **maturity** (when principal is repaid), **YTM (Yield to Maturity)** = the total annual return if held to maturity.

The single most important bond idea — price and yield move inversely: If you hold a bond paying 6% and market rates rise to 8%, your 6% bond looks unattractive, so its **price falls** until its effective yield matches ~8% (and vice-versa).

- *Why:* a new buyer won't pay full price for your lower coupon when they can get 8% elsewhere.

Credit rating: agencies (CRISIL, ICRA, CARE; globally S&P, Moody's, Fitch) grade default risk **AAA (safest) → D (default)**. Lower rating → issuer must pay a higher yield (a "credit spread").

How it trades: Government bonds are liquid; most corporate bonds trade **OTC** (over-the-counter, dealer-to-dealer).

Outside factors: **central-bank interest rates** (the biggest driver), inflation, the issuer's creditworthiness, demand for safe assets.

Example: You buy a Rs 1,000, 5-year bond with a 6% coupon → Rs 60/year for 5 years, then Rs 1,000 back. If the RBI hikes rates, the market price of your bond drops (someone buying it now wants a higher yield).

C3. DERIVATIVES (the big topic — go deep)

What it is: A derivative is a **contract whose value is derived from an underlying** asset (a stock, index, bond, currency, commodity, or interest rate). You're not trading the asset itself — you're trading a *contract linked to its price*.

Why they exist — three users (memorise):

1. **Hedgers** — reduce an existing risk (insurance). *E.g., an exporter locks a USD/INR rate.*
2. **Speculators** — take a bet on price direction for profit (with leverage).
3. **Arbitrageurs** — exploit tiny price differences for near-risk-free profit, keeping markets efficient.

The two markets they trade in (key distinction):

- **Exchange-traded:** standardised, listed on an exchange, **guaranteed by a clearing house (CCP)**, daily margining → low counterparty risk (e.g., Nifty futures).
- **OTC (Over-The-Counter):** customised, negotiated **bilaterally** between two parties → flexible but carries **counterparty risk** (e.g., an interest-rate swap). *Most of eClerx's derivative-support work is OTC.*

C3.1 Forwards

- **What:** a **customised OTC** agreement to buy/sell an asset at a fixed price on a future date.
- **Pros/cons:** flexible, but illiquid and carries **counterparty risk** (no exchange guarantee); settled at maturity.

- **Example:** A jeweller agrees today to buy 1 kg gold at Rs 70 lakh in 3 months, locking the price regardless of where gold goes.

C3.2 Futures

- **What:** a **standardised, exchange-traded forward, cleared by a CCP and marked-to-market daily** (gains/losses settled in cash each day via a margin account).
- **Why it's safer than a forward:** the CCP guarantees the trade and daily margining stops losses from piling up → minimal counterparty risk.
- **Forward vs Future (classic question):** OTC/custom/counterparty-risk/settled-at-maturity vs exchange/standardised/CCP-cleared/daily-margined.
- **Example:** You buy one Nifty future; if Nifty rises today, cash is credited to your margin account tonight; if it falls, cash is debited.

C3.3 Options (most detailed — interviewers probe here)

- **What:** the **right, but not the obligation**, to buy or sell an underlying at a fixed **strike price** by/at expiry.
- **Call option** = right to **buy**. **Put option** = right to **sell**.
- **Buyer vs Seller:** the **buyer pays a premium** and has the right (max loss = the premium). The **seller (writer) receives the premium** and takes on the obligation (limited gain = premium, potentially large loss).
- **Premium = Intrinsic value + Time value.**
- *Intrinsic value* = how much it's "in the money" right now.
- *Time value* = extra paid for the chance it moves favourably before expiry (decays to zero at expiry — "time decay").
- **What moves an option's price (the 6 drivers):** underlying price, strike, **time to expiry**, **volatility** (the big one — more volatility = more valuable), interest rates, dividends.
- **The Greeks (sensitivities):** **Delta** (sensitivity to underlying price), **Gamma** (rate of change of delta), **Theta** (time decay), **Vega** (sensitivity to volatility), **Rho** (sensitivity to interest rates).
- **Example:** You buy a Rs 100-strike call for a Rs 5 premium. If the stock goes to Rs 120, you exercise: gain Rs 20 – Rs 5 = Rs 15. If it stays below Rs 100, you let it expire and lose only the Rs 5 premium.

C3.4 Swaps

- **What:** an agreement to **exchange cash flows** over time.
- **Interest Rate Swap (IRS)** — the most common: two parties swap **fixed-rate for floating-rate** interest on a notional amount. *Use:* a company with a floating loan that fears rising rates swaps to pay fixed → locks its cost.
- **Currency swap** — exchange principal + interest in two different currencies.
- **Credit Default Swap (CDS)** — "insurance" against a borrower defaulting; the buyer pays a premium, the seller pays out if a default happens. (Central to the 2008 crisis.)
- **Example:** A firm paying floating interest (say repo + 2%) worries rates will rise. It enters an IRS to **pay 8% fixed and receive floating** → its cost is now fixed regardless of rate moves.

C4. A quick word on FX (currencies)

Currencies trade in pairs (USD/INR). A **weaker rupee** helps Indian **exporters** (IT, pharma earn USD, convert to more INR) and hurts **importers** (oil, who pay more INR for the same dollars). The role often supports **FX confirmations/settlements**, so know **spot** (settle ~T+2) vs **forward** (future-dated) FX.

PART D — THE TRADE LIFE CYCLE □ (the #1 question — master every stage)

Why this is THE topic: eClerx's Financial Markets job is supporting the trade lifecycle. There's a ~99% chance you'll be asked **"What is the trade life cycle?"** Be able to walk all the stages smoothly, in order, and explain what happens, why it matters, who does it, and what can go wrong at each.

D0. The big picture (one-line meaning)

When a trader clicks "buy", the deal is only **agreed** — not done. The trade life cycle is **everything that turns that agreement into a completed, recorded, risk-free exchange of cash for securities — and keeps the books accurate afterwards**. Operations exists so that *nothing breaks between "trade agreed" and "trade settled and reported."*

D1. The stages, in order (learn this sequence)

Pre-Trade → Order & Execution → Trade Capture → Enrichment & Validation → Confirmation & Affirmation → Clearing → Settlement → Reconciliation → Reporting / Books & Records.

Now each stage — meaning, why, who, what can go wrong:

Stage 1 — Pre-Trade

- **What:** before any order goes out — research/decision, **compliance & limit checks** (is this allowed? within risk limits?), **KYC** of the client/counterparty must be valid.
- **Why it matters:** stops illegal/over-limit trades *before* they happen.
- **Office:** Front (with middle-office risk support).
- **Goes wrong:** trading a restricted stock, or breaching a position limit → compliance breach.

Stage 2 — Order & Execution

- **What:** the order is sent to a venue and **executed** (matched with a buyer/seller). On an **exchange** (equities, futures) it's anonymous and matched on the order book; **OTC** (swaps, many bonds) it's negotiated directly with a counterparty.
- **Output:** an execution with price, quantity, time, security, counterparty.
- **Example:** a fund's order to buy 50,000 Infosys shares fills on NSE at Rs 1,500.

Stage 3 — Trade Capture / Booking

- **What:** the trade is **recorded in the bank's trading system** with all economic terms — security, buy/sell, quantity, price, trade date, **value/settlement date**, counterparty, currency, fees.
- **Why it matters:** everything downstream uses this record; an error here cascades.
- **Goes wrong:** **fat-finger errors** (1,000 vs 10,000), wrong buy/sell, wrong security.

Stage 4 — Enrichment & Validation (heart of the middle office — core eClerx work)

- **What:** the raw trade is **enriched with reference/static data** needed to process it: **SSIs (Standard Settlement Instructions** — which accounts cash & securities settle to), account & legal-entity data, security identifiers (**ISIN/CUSIP/SEDOL**), calendars/holidays. Then **validated** (does the price look right vs market?).
- **Why it matters:** **~80% of settlement failures trace back to bad/missing static data here.** This is exactly the kind of accuracy work eClerx does.
- **Goes wrong:** wrong SSI → cash sent to the wrong place; wrong ISIN → wrong security.

Stage 5 — Confirmation & Affirmation (a huge eClerx service line)

- **What:** both sides **legally agree the trade terms before settlement**.
- **Confirmation** = the formal agreement of all economic terms **between the two counterparties** (a confirm document/message).
- **Affirmation** = the client/investment manager **agreeing the broker's version** of the trade.

- **Matching** = comparing trade fields on both sides; if everything agrees → "matched/confirmed"; if not → an **exception / break** to investigate.
- **Tools to name: DTCC's CTM/Oasys, MarkitWire** (OTC derivatives), **SWIFT** messages.
- **Why it matters:** OTC trades are negotiated by phone/chat, so this is the control that **catches mismatches before money moves**.
- **Example:** you booked 10,000 shares; the broker confirms 1,000 → a break you must resolve before settlement.

Stage 6 — Clearing

- **What:** between trade and settlement, a **Clearing House / CCP (Central Counterparty)** steps in.
- **Novation:** the CCP becomes "buyer to every seller and seller to every buyer" → you now face the CCP, not the original counterparty → counterparty risk is largely removed.
- **Netting:** the CCP nets all your trades to a single net obligation per security/currency → far fewer, smaller settlements.
- **Margin:** members post **initial margin** (upfront buffer) and **variation margin** (daily mark-to-market top-ups) so the CCP is protected if a member defaults.
- **India:** NSE Clearing (NSCCL) / ICCL. **Why it matters:** turns a web of risky bilateral promises into a guaranteed, efficient system (a key post-2008 reform for OTC derivatives).

Stage 7 — Settlement

- **What:** the actual exchange — **securities delivered, cash paid**.
- **DvP (Delivery versus Payment):** securities and cash move **simultaneously**, so neither side can pay and get nothing (removes "principal risk").
- **Settlement cycle: India equities = T+1** (one business day after trade); US moved to T+1 in 2024. **Depositories** (NSDL/CDSL) hold securities in demat form; cash moves via accounts (**Nostro** = our account with another bank, in foreign currency; **Vostro** = their account with us).
- **Goes wrong — a "settlement fail":** one side can't deliver (securities unavailable, wrong SSI, missed cut-off) → leads to **buy-ins**, penalties and claims. Managing fails is a daily ops job.

Stage 8 — Reconciliation (the definitional eClerx activity)

- **What:** **match internal records against external records** to prove the books are accurate.
- **Nostro reconciliation** = internal cash ledger vs the bank statement.
- **Position / Depot reconciliation** = internal securities holdings vs the custodian/depository.
- **Inter-system reconciliation** = front-office book vs back-office/accounting system.
- A mismatch is a **break**; you investigate root cause → fix → re-match → escalate aged breaks → document (see D3).

Stage 9 — Reporting, Books & Records, Custody

- **What:** **regulatory reporting** of trades to repositories (post-2008 transparency rules — **Dodd-Frank/SDR** in the US, **EMIR** in Europe, **MiFID II** transaction reporting); **client reporting**; ongoing **custody & asset servicing** (handling **corporate actions**, income, tax on held securities).

D2. Front/Middle/Back office mapping (one-liner)

Front = execute (Stages 1–2). Middle = capture, enrich, confirm, risk (Stages 3–5). Back = clear, settle, reconcile, report (Stages 6–9). **eClerx = middle + back**.

D3. Trade breaks & exceptions — YOUR DAILY JOB (rehearse this)

A **break** is any mismatch between two records that should agree.

- **Common causes:** booking/fat-finger error, **wrong or missing SSI/static data**, timing differences, FX-rate or fee mismatches, a corporate action not applied, duplicate/missing entries.
- **How you resolve it (say this exact workflow):**

1. **Identify** the break (the system flags a mismatch).
 2. **Investigate the root cause** — compare both records field by field.
 3. **Liaise** with the counterparty/custodian/internal desk (email/call) to confirm correct details.
 4. **Correct** the wrong record / fix the static data / re-book.
 5. **Re-match** and confirm the break clears.
 6. **Escalate** aged/large breaks per the escalation matrix, and **document** the resolution for audit.
- **Why it matters:** unresolved breaks mean unrecorded risk, P&L errors, failed settlements, regulatory penalties, unhappy clients. **Attention to detail + timely escalation are the prized qualities.**

D4. OTC derivative trade — a few extra steps (good to know for "Derivative Trade Support")

For an OTC swap: execution → **confirmation against an ISDA Master Agreement** (the standard legal framework for OTC derivatives) + a **CSA (Credit Support Annex)** governing collateral → clearing (if eligible) or bilateral with collateral → **lifecycle events** over the trade's life (interest resets, coupon exchanges, novations, terminations) → **collateral/margin management** (daily valuation, margin calls) → **regulatory reporting**.

D5. One-paragraph answer you can say out loud

"A trade moves from pre-trade checks and execution, to being captured in the system, enriched with settlement and reference data, then confirmed and matched with the counterparty. It's cleared through a CCP that novates and nets the trade and takes margin, then settled on a delivery-versus-payment basis — T+1 for Indian equities — with securities moving through the depository and cash through nostro accounts. Operations then reconciles internal books against custodian and cash statements, investigates and resolves any breaks, and the trade is reported to regulators and recorded. The front office executes; the middle and back office — where eClerx works — make sure it's correct, agreed, de-risked, settled, reconciled and reported."

PART E — CAPITAL MARKETS OPERATIONS (the desks you may sit on)

E1. Corporate Actions (very likely asked — tie to your equity-research background)

What it is: an **event initiated by a company that affects its securities/shareholders**.

Three types:

- **Mandatory** — happens automatically, holder has no choice: **dividend, bonus issue, stock split, merger, spin-off**.
- **Voluntary** — holder chooses to participate: **rights issue, buyback/tender offer, optional conversion**.
- **Mandatory with options** — mandatory event with a choice, e.g., **dividend taken as cash or shares**.

Key dates (know the order): **Announcement** → **Ex-date** (buy on/after this and you do NOT get the benefit) → **Record date** (holders on the books are entitled) → **Pay date** (entitlement paid). *Under T+1, ex-date is usually one business day before record date.*

What each does (and price impact):

- **Dividend:** cash paid per share; price typically drops ~by the dividend on the ex-date.

- **Bonus issue:** free extra shares from reserves (e.g., 1:1 doubles shares); price halves — *no change in total value*, just more, cheaper shares.
- **Stock split:** face value split (e.g., 1 share → 5); price drops proportionally; improves liquidity.
- **Rights issue:** existing holders can buy more shares at a discount (optional) — raises capital, can dilute non-participants.

Ops job: interpret the event, compute entitlements, adjust positions/prices, collect elections, post entitlements, reconcile. **Errors here directly cost clients money** — so accuracy is critical.

Example: Company declares a 1:1 bonus. A holder of 100 shares at Rs 200 ends with 200 shares at ~Rs 100 — same Rs 20,000 value. Ops must apply this to every client position on the right date.

E2. KYC / AML

What it is: **KYC = Know Your Customer; AML = Anti-Money-Laundering.** Verifying who a client really is and ensuring they aren't laundering money or financing terrorism.

How: collect identity documents, identify the **beneficial owner** (who really controls it), screen against **sanctions lists & PEPs (Politically Exposed Persons)**, assign a **risk rating**, and do **ongoing monitoring / periodic refresh**. **CDD** = standard Customer Due Diligence; **EDD** = Enhanced Due Diligence for high-risk clients.

Why it matters: regulatory mandate (PMLA in India, FATF globally); onboarding a sanctioned entity → huge fines + reputational damage.

Example: before a bank trades for a new hedge-fund client, ops verifies its registration, owners, and sanctions status.

E3. Reference / Static Data

What it is: the **master data** every process relies on — **security identifiers (ISIN/CUSIP/SEDOL), prices, counterparty/legal-entity data (LEI), SSIs, calendars.**

Why it matters: garbage in → breaks everywhere; **most settlement fails come from bad static data.** This is foundational, accuracy-obsessed work.

Example: if a security's ISIN is mapped wrong, the trade tries to settle the wrong instrument and fails.

E4. Reconciliation (covered in D8 — be ready to define types)

Matching two sets of records and resolving differences: **Nostro (cash), Depot/position (securities), inter-system.**

E5. Settlements & Fails

Ensure **DvP**, monitor **cut-off times** and market calendars, manage **fails** (buy-ins, claims), handle cash & securities movement.

E6. Collateral / Margin management (for OTC derivatives desks)

Under the **ISDA/CSA**, value positions daily, issue/meet **margin calls**, move collateral, resolve disputes. Protects both sides if one defaults.

E7. Regulatory Reporting

Report trades to repositories for transparency: **Dodd-Frank/SDR (US), EMIR (EU), MiFID II, SFTR.** Born from the **2008 crisis**, when opaque OTC derivatives hid systemic risk. **Goes wrong:** late/incorrect reporting → regulatory fines.

PART F — MACRO & OUTSIDE FACTORS (how the world moves markets)

Mental model: markets are a "discounting machine." Macro variables hit prices through just two channels: **(1) they change expected company earnings/cash flows, and (2) they change the discount rate (interest rates / required return).** For each factor: what it is → how it transmits → which sectors win/lose → an example.

F1. Interest rates (RBI repo rate) — the master lever

- **What:** the **repo rate** is the rate at which the RBI lends to banks — the anchor for all borrowing costs.
- **Transmission:** repo **cut** → cheaper loans → people/companies borrow & spend more → demand & earnings rise → equities rise (and the lower discount rate lifts valuations). A **hike** does the reverse (used to fight inflation).
- **Sector impact:** rate **cuts** help **rate-sensitive sectors** — **Banks, NBFCs, Auto, Real Estate, Infra** (cheaper loans drive demand). Hikes hurt high-debt firms; bond prices fall.
- **Example:** RBI cuts repo 50 bps → Bank Nifty and auto stocks rally on cheaper-credit hopes.

F2. Inflation (CPI)

- **What:** the rate at which prices rise. RBI's target is **4% CPI (±2%)**.
- **Transmission:** high inflation → RBI hikes rates → valuations compress; also **raises input costs**, squeezing company margins.
- **Sector impact:** hurts **consumer discretionary** (people cut spending); **FMCG** is defensive but faces input-cost pressure; commodity producers can benefit.
- **Example:** 2022's inflation surge pushed RBI to hike from 4% → 6.5%; high-P/E stocks de-rated, banks outperformed.

F3. Currency (USD/INR)

- **What:** the rupee's value vs the dollar.
- **Transmission/sectors:** a **weaker rupee** helps **exporters (IT, Pharma)** (earn USD → more INR) and hurts **importers (Oil & Gas, Aviation)** (costlier imports, wider deficit). A stronger rupee does the reverse.
- **Example:** rupee falls 83 → 86/USD → TCS/Infosys margins get a tailwind; oil marketing companies' import bill rises.

F4. Crude oil — India's Achilles' heel

- **What:** India imports ~85% of its oil, so crude drives the import bill, inflation, the rupee and the fiscal deficit.
- **Sector impact:** oil **up** → bad for India broadly; hurts **Aviation, Paints, Tyres, Logistics, OMCs**; helps upstream producers (ONGC).
- **Example:** a Middle-East flare-up spikes Brent → airline and paint stocks fall, rupee weakens, inflation worries return.

F5. Growth (GDP) & the cycle

- **Expansion:** **cyclicals** lead — Banks, Auto, Metals, Infra, Capital Goods.
- **Slowdown/uncertainty:** **defensives** lead — FMCG, Pharma, IT, Utilities.
- This **sector rotation** framework is impressive to mention.

F6. Global cues & flows

- **US Fed hikes / strong dollar** → FIIs pull money to safer US assets → **Indian equities fall, rupee weakens.**
- **DII (mutual funds, LIC) + steady SIP inflows** increasingly cushion FII selling — a structural support for Indian markets.
- **Geopolitics / supply shocks** → commodity spikes, risk-off sentiment.

F7. The flagship "linking" answer (rehearse — shows real analytical range)

"If crude spikes on a geopolitical shock, India's import bill rises, the rupee weakens, and inflation ticks up — so the RBI may hold or hike rates, keeping the discount rate high and pressuring valuations, especially for high-P/E stocks. Aviation, paints and tyres get hit on margins, OMCs face pressure, while IT and pharma benefit from the weaker rupee. FIIs may turn risk-off and sell, though DII/SIP inflows can cushion the fall."

PART G — CORPORATE FINANCE & VALUATION BASICS (play to your resume)

*Your resume shows **DCF, comps, financial modelling, equity research**. The interviewer will ask about it. Be ready to explain these simply.*

G1. The three financial statements & how they link

- **Income Statement (P&L):** performance over a period — Revenue — Expenses = Net Profit.
- **Balance Sheet:** a snapshot — **Assets = Liabilities + Equity.**
- **Cash Flow Statement:** actual cash moving — Operating + Investing + Financing.
- **The link (classic question):** net profit flows from the P&L into **retained earnings** (Balance Sheet) and is the **starting line** of the cash flow statement; depreciation is added back in cash flow; ending cash sits on the balance sheet. *Everything reconciles.*

G2. Key ratios (define + interpret)

- **Profitability:** gross/operating/net margin, **ROE** (Net income/Equity), **ROCE** (EBIT/Capital employed).
- **Leverage:** Debt/Equity, Interest coverage (EBIT/Interest).
- **Liquidity:** Current ratio, Quick ratio.
- **Valuation:** **P/E, EV/EBITDA** (capital-structure-neutral), P/B, dividend yield.

G3. DCF (Discounted Cash Flow) — your strength, explained simply

- **Idea:** a company is worth the **present value of the cash it will generate in future.**
- **Steps:** project **Free Cash Flow** for ~10 years → discount each year at the **WACC** (weighted average cost of capital) → add a **Terminal Value** for cash beyond the forecast (Gordon Growth: $FCF \times (1+g)/(WACC-g)$) → sum = **Enterprise Value** → add net cash → **Equity Value** → ÷ shares = **value per share.**
- **Why powerful / its weakness:** captures intrinsic value, but is **very sensitive to assumptions** (WACC, growth) — so always show a range/sensitivity.
- **FCFF formula:** $FCFF = EBIT \times (1 - \text{tax}) + D\&A - \text{Capex} - \text{change in working capital}.$

G4. Comparable Company Analysis ("comps")

Value a company using **peer multiples** (EV/EBITDA, P/E). Quick and market-based, but assumes peers are fairly valued. *Used as a cross-check on the DCF.*

G5. WACC & cost of capital (one line)

WACC = blended cost of equity and after-tax debt = the discount rate / hurdle rate. **Cost of equity** via **CAPM**: $Re = Rf + \beta(Rm - Rf)$. Higher risk (beta) → higher required return → lower valuation.

PART H — EXCEL & DATA SKILLS (they test this; you're strong here)

Functions to know cold: VLOOKUP / XLOOKUP / INDEX-MATCH (know why INDEX-MATCH beats VLOOKUP — left-lookups, insertion-safe); IF / nested IF / IFERROR; SUMIF(S) / COUNTIF(S) / AVERAGEIF(S); text functions (LEFT/RIGHT/MID/TRIM/LEN/CONCAT); **Pivot Tables**; filters/sort; **Remove Duplicates**; **Conditional Formatting**; **Data Validation**; **Text-to-Columns**.

Reconciliation-relevant (mention this — it's literally the job): comparing two lists to find mismatches using =A2=B2, COUNTIF, or MATCH — exactly how you'd spot a trade/cash break.

If asked "most complex Excel problem you solved": give a real example from your work (e.g., automating a reconciliation/variance report, building a dynamic DCF with scenarios) — describe the problem, the functions you used, and the time saved.

PART I — APTITUDE, LOGICAL REASONING & ENGLISH/VERSANT (the screening round)

*The first hurdle is an **online test (quant + reasoning + English)** and a **Versant communication test**. This round screens out more people than the technical round, so don't neglect it. Speed × accuracy is the game.*

I1. Quantitative Aptitude — topics + the formula/shortcut for each

Memorise first: **tables to 20, squares to 30, cubes to 15, and fraction↔% conversions** ($1/8=12.5\%$, $1/6=16.67\%$, $1/7 \approx 14.28\%$, $1/3=33.3\%$). This alone adds huge speed.

Topic	Key formula / trick
Percentages	% change = $(\text{new} - \text{old}) / \text{old} \times 100$; successive a% then b% = $a+b+ab/100$ (e.g., +20% then -20% = -4%, not 0)
Profit & Loss	Profit% = $(SP - CP) / CP \times 100$; $SP = CP \times (1 + P\%)$; beware false-weight gains
Simple/Compound Interest	$SI = PRT/100$; $A = P(1 + R/100)^T$; CI-SI for 2 yrs = $P(R/100)^2$
Ratio & Proportion	$a:b=c:d \rightarrow ad=bc$; partnership profit $\propto$ capital $\times$ time
Averages & Mixtures	Avg = sum/n ; alligation: $(\text{cheaper qty}) / (\text{dearer qty}) = (\text{dearer} - \text{mean}) / (\text{mean} - \text{cheaper})$
Time, Speed, Distance	speed = dist/time ; $\text{km/hr} \rightarrow \text{m/s} \times 5/18$; relative speed (add if opposite, subtract if same dir); trains/boats
Time & Work	A in a days $\rightarrow 1/a$ per day; combine $1/a + 1/b$; assume total work = LCM for speed
Number system	divisibility rules, $HCF \times LCM = \text{product}$, unit-digit cyclicity
P&C / Probability	$nPr = n! / (n-r)!$; $nCr = n! / [r!(n-r)!]$; $P = \text{favourable}/\text{total}$
Data Interpretation (DI)	tables/bar/pie — highest marks per minute ; approximate, don't over-compute

Worked example (a classic trap): Salary rises 25%. To get back to the original, decrease by $25/125 \times 100 = 20\%$ (not 25%).

Exam tactics: two-pass (do easy first, flag hard); eliminate MCQ options by approximation/unit-digit; never burn 3 minutes on one question.

12. Logical Reasoning — topics + how to attack

- **Series** (number/letter): find the pattern (differences, ratios, squares). e.g., 2, 6, 12, 20, 30, ? $\rightarrow +4, +6, +8, +10 \rightarrow 42$.
- **Coding-Decoding:** letter $\leftrightarrow$ position shifts. CAT $\rightarrow$ DBU = each +1.
- **Blood relations / Directions:** always draw a diagram; shortest distance = $\sqrt{(x^2 + y^2)}$.
- **Seating arrangement & puzzles:** list clues, fix the most definite clue first, build a grid, eliminate.
- **Syllogisms:** use Venn diagrams; a conclusion is valid only if true in every possible diagram.
- **Clocks/Calendars:** clock angle = $|30H - 5.5M|$; calendars use "odd days".
- **Statement-Assumption/Conclusion:** use only the given facts, never outside knowledge.

13. English (written)

- **Most-tested:** subject-verb agreement, tenses, articles, prepositions, error-spotting, sentence correction, synonyms/antonyms, one-word substitution, reading comprehension, para-jumbles, fill-in-the-blanks.
- **Confusables to revise:** affect/effect, principal/principle, its/it's, stationary/stationery, complement/compliment.
- **RC tip:** read the questions first, then scan; don't infer beyond the text.

14. THE VERSANT TEST (automated spoken English) — how to ace it

eClerx (like many KPOs) uses **Versant** (by Pearson) — an **AI-scored** spoken-English test (~17 min) judging **fluency, pronunciation, vocabulary, sentence mastery**. Six task types:

1. **Read Aloud** — read printed sentences clearly.
2. **Repeat Sentences** — listen, then repeat exactly.
3. **Short-Answer Questions** — answer a simple question in a word/phrase.
4. **Sentence Builds** — rearrange given chunks into a correct sentence.
5. **Story Retelling** — listen to a passage, then summarise it.
6. **Open Questions** — speak for ~30–45 seconds on a topic.

How to score high (what the machine rewards):

- **Speak clearly at a steady, natural pace** — not too fast, no trailing off, no long pauses.
- **Pronounce word endings fully** (says, asked, fixed) — don't swallow them.
- **No fillers** ("um", "like", "actually"); no mumbling.
- For **Repeat**: listen to the *whole* sentence, then repeat fluidly (don't start early).
- For **Read Aloud**: keep rhythm; pause at commas/full stops.
- For **Open Questions**: give **2-4 complete, grammatical sentences** with a clear structure (point $\rightarrow$ reason $\rightarrow$ example).

How to improve in a few days: read business news **aloud** 15–20 min/day (Economic Times/Mint); **shadow** a news anchor to fix rhythm/pronunciation; record yourself and replay; take a free online Versant mock to get used to the format.

Sample Open-Question answer (reusable structure — point $\rightarrow$ example):

"My biggest strength is analytical rigour. For instance, in my equity-research work I build valuation models and cross-check financial statements carefully, which makes me detail-oriented and comfortable with data — exactly what trade-support operations need."

PART J — TECHNICAL Q&A BANK (rehearse the answers out loud)

Keep answers **crisp and confident**. If unsure, reason from first principles. Tie back to: what it is → why → example.

Trade lifecycle & operations

- 1. What is the trade life cycle?** → Walk the 9 stages: pre-trade → execution → capture → enrichment/validation → confirmation/affirmation → clearing → settlement → reconciliation → reporting. (Use the one-paragraph answer in D5.)
- 2. Front vs middle vs back office?** → Front executes/makes money; middle manages risk & supports/confirms trades; back settles, reconciles, reports. eClerx = middle + back.
- 3. What is a trade break and how do you resolve it?** → A mismatch between two records; investigate root cause → liaise with counterparty/custodian → correct/re-book → re-match → escalate aged items → document.
- 4. What is confirmation vs affirmation?** → Confirmation = legal agreement of terms between counterparties; affirmation = client agreeing the broker's trade details.
- 5. What is settlement / DvP?** → Exchange of securities for cash; DvP = both move simultaneously, removing principal risk.
- 6. What is the settlement cycle in India?** → T+1 for equities (one business day after trade); US moved to T+1 in 2024.
- 7. What is a clearing house / CCP?** → A central counterparty that novates (becomes buyer to seller & seller to buyer), nets obligations, and takes margin — removing counterparty risk.
- 8. Nostro vs Vostro?** → Nostro = "our account with another bank" (often foreign currency); Vostro = "their account with us."
- 9. What is reconciliation? Types?** → Matching internal vs external records; Nostro (cash), Depot/position (securities), inter-system.
- 10. Why is reference/static data important?** → Most settlement fails come from bad SSIs/security data; it underpins enrichment, settlement and recon.
- 11. What is an SSI?** → Standard Settlement Instructions — pre-agreed account details for where cash/securities settle.
- 12. What is an ISIN?** → International Securities Identification Number — a unique global ID for a security.

Asset classes

- 13. Equity vs debt?** → Equity = ownership, variable returns (dividends + gains), paid last in liquidation, voting rights; debt = a loan, fixed coupon, paid first, no ownership.
- 14. Primary vs secondary market?** → First issuance (money to the issuer, e.g., IPO) vs trading existing securities between investors (liquidity & price discovery).
- 15. Why do bond prices and yields move inversely?** → A fixed coupon becomes relatively less/more attractive when market rates change, so the price adjusts until the yield matches the market.
- 16. What is YTM?** → Yield to Maturity — the total annual return if you hold the bond to maturity.
- 17. What is a corporate action? Give types & dates.** → An issuer event affecting securities; mandatory (dividend, bonus, split, merger), voluntary (rights, buyback), mandatory-with-options; key dates: ex-date, record date, pay date.

18. What happens to the price on a bonus issue / stock split / ex-dividend? → Bonus & split: price drops proportionally, total value unchanged; ex-dividend: price drops ~by the dividend.

Derivatives

19. What is a derivative & why used? → A contract deriving value from an underlying; used to hedge, speculate or arbitrage.

20. Forward vs future (4 differences)? → OTC/customised/counterparty-risk/settled-at-maturity vs exchange/standardised/CCP-cleared/daily-margined.

21. Call vs put option? → Call = right to buy; put = right to sell, at the strike by expiry.

22. Max loss for an option buyer vs seller? → Buyer: the premium; seller: potentially large/unlimited.

23. What drives an option's premium most? → Volatility (plus underlying price, strike, time, rates, dividends). Premium = intrinsic + time value.

24. What is an interest rate swap and who uses it? → Exchange fixed-for-floating interest on a notional; used by firms to convert floating-rate exposure to fixed (hedge rising rates).

25. What is a CDS? → Credit Default Swap — insurance against a borrower defaulting; central to the 2008 crisis.

26. What is marking-to-market / a margin call? → Daily settlement of futures gains/losses; a margin call asks you to top up when the position moves against you.

27. What is the ISDA Master Agreement? → The standard legal framework governing OTC derivatives between two parties (terms, netting, default).

Markets, valuation & macro

28. How do the three financial statements link? → Net profit → retained earnings (BS) and the start of the cash-flow statement; depreciation added back; ending cash on the BS.

29. Walk me through a DCF. → Project free cash flows → discount at WACC → add terminal value → EV → add net cash → equity value → ÷ shares.

30. NPV vs IRR — which is better? → NPV (absolute value created; IRR has reinvestment/scale/multiple-IRR pitfalls).

31. EV vs equity value? → EV = whole firm to all capital providers; equity value = EV + net cash (value to shareholders).

32. What happens to markets when the RBI cuts rates? → Cheaper credit; banks/auto/realty rally; valuations rise.

33. Why does a weak rupee help IT/pharma? → They earn in USD; a weaker rupee converts to more INR.

34. Which sectors are hurt by rising crude? → Aviation, paints, tyres, OMCs, logistics; ONGC benefits.

35. What is hedging vs speculation? → Reducing an existing risk vs taking on risk for profit.

Excel/data

36. How would you find mismatches between two lists in Excel? → =A2=B2, or COUNTIF/MATCH/VLOOKUP to flag items present in one list but not the other — exactly how a recon break is spotted.

37. VLOOKUP vs INDEX-MATCH? → INDEX-MATCH can look left, isn't broken by inserting columns, and is faster on large data.

PART K — eClerx FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (company & role)

Is eClerx a BPO or KPO? → Primarily a **KPO** — knowledge-intensive, judgement-based, domain-expert work (it also offers some BPO).

What does eClerx do? → Provides middle/back-office operations, analytics and digital services to Fortune-500 clients; in financial markets it supports the trade lifecycle, reconciliations, reference data, corporate actions, KYC and regulatory reporting for global banks.

When founded / HQ / CEO? → Founded 2000; HQ Mumbai (large Pune operations); listed on Indian exchanges; CEO **Kapil Jain**.

Which clients? → Global investment banks, asset managers, and other Fortune-500 firms (financial services, telecom/media, retail, tech).

What will I do in this role? → Support stages of the trade lifecycle — trade capture/validation, confirmation/matching, resolving breaks, settlement support, corporate actions, reconciliations and reporting.

Day/night shifts? → Global clients mean rotational shifts (APAC/EMEA/NAM). Be ready to state your preference (a day/APAC shift) with a reason.

How many rounds? → Typically 3-4: aptitude/online test, communication (Versant), technical/operations, HR.

Is the interview hard? → Medium (~2.8/5). Clarity of fundamentals + communication matter most; the trade lifecycle is near-guaranteed.

PART L — BEHAVIOURAL / HR QUESTIONS (tailored to YOUR resume, with framed answers)

Use the **STAR** method for "tell me about a time..." questions: **Situation** → **Task** → **Action** → **Result**.

Below, answers are pre-framed from your real background (EY-GDS Strategy & Transactions, MBA Finance & Business Analytics, independent equity research, Power BI/SQL/Excel). Adapt wording to sound natural — don't memorise robotically.

L1. The three you MUST nail (your profile raises these)

Q: Tell me about yourself.

"I'm an MBA in Finance & Business Analytics and an ex-Associate Analyst at EY-GDS, Strategy & Transactions, where I worked on financial analysis, peer benchmarking and Power BI reporting for global clients. Since then I've run independent equity research — building DCF and comparable-company models across sectors. I'm strong in Excel, SQL and Power BI, and I understand the trade lifecycle and capital markets. I'm looking for a capital-markets operations role where that analytical background and attention to detail add value from day one."

Q: You have an MBA and EY experience — why this operations analyst role? (the "overqualified" question)

"I want to build a long-term career in capital markets, and operations is where you learn how the market actually works end-to-end — the trade lifecycle, products, and controls. eClerx is a leader in this space with global banking clients, so it's the right place to build deep, practical domain expertise. My analytical background means I can contribute quickly and grow with the role."

Q: Why did you leave EY-GDS after only a few months? / Explain the gap since then.

"My EY-GDS role was a defined engagement. When it concluded, I made a deliberate choice to deepen my core interest — equity research and valuation — rather than take an unrelated role. I've kept building real skills: analysing companies, building models, and staying close to markets. I'm now fully focused on committing to a long-term role in capital markets, which is exactly what this is." (Calm, confident, one sentence on the gap, then pivot to value. Never apologise.)

L2. Motivation & fit

Q: Why do you want to work at eClerx?

"eClerx is a leading KPO supporting global investment banks across the trade lifecycle. The work matches my finance background, and the domain depth I'd build — products, settlements, reconciliations, regulatory reporting — is exactly the expertise I want. It's a place where my analytical skills are useful and where I can grow."

Q: Where do you see yourself in 5-10 years?

"Growing within capital markets — moving from Analyst to Senior Analyst and into a subject-matter or process-management role, ideally with a CFA along the way, owning more complex processes and mentoring juniors."

Q: Why should we hire you?

"I combine finance domain knowledge with strong data skills — Excel, SQL, Power BI — and a detail-oriented, deadline-driven mindset from my EY and research work. I'll ramp up fast on the trade lifecycle and be reliable on accuracy and escalation, which is what operations needs."

L3. STAR competency questions (use real examples)

Q: Tell me about a time you worked under pressure / tight deadline. (EY-GDS reporting)

S: At EY-GDS we had tight client deadlines for benchmarking reports. **T:** I had to deliver an accurate Power BI dashboard and management report under time pressure. **A:** I prioritised the critical analyses, automated repetitive steps in Excel/Power BI, and validated the numbers before submission. **R:** Delivered on time with clean data, and the automation made future refreshes faster.

Q: Tell me about a time you spotted an error / your attention to detail. (equity research)

S: While building a valuation model, I noticed historical ratios (ROE, working capital) didn't tie to the financial statements. **T:** I had to find and fix the inconsistency before the model could be trusted. **A:** I traced it line by line, corrected the timeline mismatch, and re-checked P&L and balance-sheet alignment. **R:** The model became internally consistent and reliable — the same root-cause discipline that resolves trade breaks.

Q: Tell me about a time you handled a difficult teammate / conflict.

S: On a group project, a teammate's section was delayed and inconsistent. **T:** I needed the overall deliverable on time without damaging the relationship. **A:** I spoke to them privately to understand the blocker, broke their part into smaller steps, and offered to help review. **R:** They delivered, we met the deadline, and the working relationship stayed positive.

Q: A time you disagreed with a manager/decision.

"I raise concerns respectfully with data. Once I felt a deadline was unrealistic given the data-cleaning needed; I explained the risk to quality with specifics and proposed a phased delivery. My manager agreed to adjust, and we delivered accurately rather than rushing errors."

Q: A time you took initiative / improved a process. (internship)

S: In my analytics internship, report generation was manual and slow. **T:** Reduce the manual effort. **A:** I built Excel automation and applied data-mining tools to streamline it. **R:** Improved report-generation efficiency by ~30%, freeing time for analysis.

Q: A time you worked in a team to achieve a goal.

Use a project/MBA example: define the shared goal, your specific contribution (analysis/modelling), how you coordinated, and the outcome.

L4. The quick-fire personal ones

- **Strengths:** analytical rigour, attention to detail, strong with data (Excel/SQL/Power BI), self-driven learner.
- **Weakness (with a fix):** "I can over-polish analysis chasing perfection; I've learned to time-box and balance depth with deadlines." (*Real, with a corrective action — never a fake weakness.*)
- **Are you comfortable with rotational shifts / monotonous process work?** "Yes — I understand operations is deadline-driven and process-oriented; I value accuracy and consistency, and I've shared my preference for a day/APAC shift."
- **Are you a team player / comfortable multitasking?** "Yes — I prioritise, communicate, and stay organised; in EY and research I juggled multiple analyses while keeping quality high."

L5. Smart questions to ASK them (always have 2-3)

- "Which desk/process would I be on — trade support, reconciliations, corporate actions, or reference data?"
- "What does success look like in the first 6 months, and what's the path to Senior Analyst?"
- "Which shift does this project run, and is transport provided for night shifts?"

PART M — FINAL PREP: CHECKLIST, TODAY-BEFORE & MINDSET**M1. Current data points to refresh the day before (so you sound current)**

RBI repo rate; latest CPI inflation; Nifty 50 & Sensex levels; USD/INR; Brent crude; India 10-year G-sec yield; one recent big market event. *Knowing these signals genuine market interest.*

M2. What to carry to the interview

3-4 printed resumes; government photo ID; educational certificates + EY experience/relieving letter; passport photos; a pen. (For a walk-in, call HR a day before to confirm.)

M3. 7-day study plan

- **Day 1-2:** Trade Life Cycle (Part D) + Capital Markets Operations (Part E) — *most important.*
- **Day 3:** Derivatives (Part C3) + asset classes.
- **Day 4:** Markets foundations (Part B) + macro (Part F).
- **Day 5:** Corporate finance/valuation (Part G) + Excel (Part H).
- **Day 6:** Aptitude + reasoning + Versant practice (Part I).
- **Day 7:** Rehearse the Technical Q&A (Part J) and Behavioural answers (Part L) **out loud** + company FAQs (Part K) + current data.

M4. The 5-layer answer habit (your edge)

For any finance concept, layer it: **meaning** → **why/how used** → **impact** → **outside factors** → **example**. That structure, plus clear communication, is exactly what separates a strong eClerx candidate.

M5. Mindset

You are an **MBA finance professional with EY-GDS experience and real research skills** — not a nervous fresher. Walk in calm, warm, specific, and ready to walk through the trade lifecycle confidently. Lead with clarity, speak in complete sentences, and tie answers back to accuracy, ownership, and the trade lifecycle.

One-line confidence anchor: *"I understand the trade lifecycle end-to-end, I'm strong with data and detail, and I'm ready to apply that to support global capital-markets clients accurately and reliably."*

Prepared as personal interview-preparation material for Apoorva Singh. Educational only — not investment advice. Verify current market data before the interview. Good luck — you've got this.